MINUTES OF THE CLARE COUNTY BOARD OF COMMISSIONERS

Approved 6-11-2024

225 W. Main St.
Harrison, Michigan 48625

~~Unapproved~~ minutes
May 15, 2024

Meeting was called to order at 9:00 a.m.

Pledge of Allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America

District 1 Marlene Housler, District 2 Dale Majewski, District 3 Samantha Pitchford, District 4 Jeff Haskell, District 5 David Hoefling, District 6 Jack Kleinhardt, District 7 Gabe Ambrozaitis, District 8 George Gilmore and District 9 Rick Fancon

COMMISSIONERS ABSENT

None

OTHERS PRESENT

Clerk & Register of Deeds Lori Mott, Administrator Lori Phelps, members of the public and zoom participants

APPROVAL OF AGENDA

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve the agenda with changes, **motion carried**

*Changes - Strike closed session from the agenda.

APPROVAL OF MINUTES

It was moved by Commissioner Hoefling, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to approve the Board of Commissioners Minutes of April 17, 2024 with changes, **motion carried**.

*Changes – typo in word being

GENERAL PUBLIC COMMENT

Mr. Raymond Elliott was present and brought his concern regarding the health issues he believes are being caused by the landfill. Mr. Elliott confirmed that he has contacted the Health Department and the EPA (Environmental Protection Agency) with no resolution. Commissioner Majewski confirmed that the Board of Commissioners has no authority to do anything about the alleged contamination of the air and ground by the landfill other than to keep pushing other agencies to do something and confirmed that the Board of Commissioners have been pushing the agencies to act.

COMMUNICATIONS LIST

a. Stats from MMR – No discussion

ADMINISTRATOR'S REPORT

Administrator Lori Phelps provided the Commissioners with updates on House Bills being considered and regarding the Governor's budget and revenue sharing. There has been a great deal of thought and effort into alternate revenue sources including consolidating jail facilities with Osceola County with a possible start date of July 1, 2024.

Administrator Phelps is working with Department Heads regarding restructuring of departments and has asked a few department heads not to replace employees' vacant positions.

JUSTICE

1. Prosecutor
   It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve the 10-year contract with Axon Justice Solutions for the purchase and maintenance of needed software, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Housler, Hoefling, Pitchford, Majewski, Fancon, Kleinhardt, Gilmore, Ambrozaitis and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried

PHYSICAL RESOURCES AND ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

1. Code Enforcement
   It was moved by Commissioner Hoefling, seconded by Commissioner Housler to approve the contract renewal between Community Development and Hayes Township for Ordinance Enforcement Services.

   Prior to roll call vote being taken it was moved by Commissioner Gilmore, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to table this until after the Committee of the Whole meeting as he found some issues with some of this and would like time to discuss at that meeting before voting on it.
   Motion to table Code Enforcement carried

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION

1. Statutory Finance Committee
   It was moved by Commissioner Pitchford, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to approve Statutory Finance Committee meeting minutes of April 15, 2024 in the amount of $52,499.55 and the meeting minutes of April 29, 2024 in the amount of $162,061.60, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Pitchford, Majewski, Ambrozaitis, Gilmore, Fancon, Kleinhardt, Hoefling, Housler and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried

2. Monthly Expenditures
   It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Ambrozaitis to approve the expenditures for the month of April 2024, in the amount of $6,845,090.07 with the General Fund expenditures totaling $903,306.48, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Majewski, Ambrozaitis, Gilmore, Fancon, Kleinhardt, Hoefling, Housler, Pitchford and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried

3. Budget Adjustments
   It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve Budget Adjustment #24-80 and Budget Adjustment #28-88, in the amounts of $77,913.49 and $334,878.39 respectively, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Hoefling, Fancon, Pitchford, Housler, Majewski, Kleinhardt, Gilmore and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION - continued

4. Register of Deeds – Indexing/Media Conversion Discussion

   a. It was moved by Commissioner Gilmore, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve the contract with Fidlar Technologies, Inc. without going out to bid, for indexing services in the amount not to exceed $227,187.00 to be paid out of the Register's Automation Fund, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Gilmore, Hoefling, Majewski, Fancon, Ambrozaitis, Kleinhardt, Housler, Pitchford, and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried

   b. It was moved by Commissioner Kleinhardt, seconded by Commissioner Gilmore to approve the contract with Fidlar Technologies, Inc. without going out to bid, for media conversion services in the amount of $32,104.43 to be paid out of the Register's Automation Fund, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Kleinhardt, Gilmore, Ambrozaitis, Housler, Hoefling, Fancon, Pitchford, Majewski and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried

CLERK/REGISTER OF DEEDS REPORT

Clerk and Register of Deeds Lori Mott gave an update regarding preparing the August 6, 2024 ballot. There will be 16 proposals on the August ballot. Clerk and Register of Deeds Mott confirmed that the cost for early voting in Clare County was $48,126.77.

Clerk and Register of Deeds Mott spoke regarding Secretary of State Benson's Intent to Negotiate in regard to a single source supplier for Michigan's logic and accuracy testing for all election equipment. Clerk and Register of Deeds Mott expressed her concern and dissatisfaction with the lack of communication with the Michigan Association of County Clerks in regard to this decision.

TREASURER'S REPORT

Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger provided all the statutory reports to the Commissioners and confirmed that 2023 ended with a $4.9 million fund balance unrestricted, which is a 33% fund balance.

CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Chairman Jeff Haskell confirmed that he feels combining Osceola County jail with the Clare County jail would be a good idea and will give regular updates as the meetings/talks continue.

VICE CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Vice Chairman Dale Majewski gave an update on the two townships he serves.

COMMISSIONER'S REPORT

Commissioner Housler has attended her meetings, but confirmed there was nothing to report.

Commissioner Hoefling gave an update regarding the townships and committees he serves.

Commissioner Pitchford has attended her meetings – no report.

Commissioner Ambrozaitis confirmed the painting and crack sealing for the County Airport, up to $80,000.00, will be totally funded by MDOT (Michigan Department of Transportation) with no county match. The Airport has received new/used lights from another airport free of charge.

Commissioner Gilmore communicated that both townships he serves are happy with current ambulance services and would be opposed to a county-wide ballot initiative.

Commissioner Kleinhardt talked about a switch from gas tax to miles traveled tax because the gas tax is failing in connection with the use of electric vehicles.

Commissioner Fancon had no report

PUBLIC COMMENT

None

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None

NEW BUSINESS

None

Meeting Adjourned at 9:52 a.m.

Lori Mott, Clerk
Clare County Board of Commissioners

Jeff Haskell, Chairman
Clare County Board of Commissioners